

Simran Singh

Third Year PhD Candidate in Political Science

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Education

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| Columbia University , New York (US) | 2022 – Present |
| PhD Student, Political Science (International Relations) | |
| Swarthmore College , Swarthmore, PA (US) | 2015 – 2019 |
| B.A. in Honors Political Science and Economics | |
| Recipient of McCabe Scholarship, full tuition scholarship in recognition of academic achievement, leadership, and community service. | |

Dissertation Project

Hollowing the Leader: A Theory of Social Policy Delegation from States to Firms

Abstract: How do governments circumvent political constraints on policy implementation, such as potential voter backlash or regime turnover-induced policy uncertainty? In my dissertation project, I argue that foreign governments in states open to foreign direct investment (FDI) have access to an important channel through which they can pursue certain types of policies with less visible involvement: the activities of multinational corporations. In particular, I investigate the idea that governments can both condition the entry of multinationals and/or threaten to alter the regulatory landscape once foreign firms have established their presence in a way that ties firms' hands. I develop a theoretical framework analyzing a state's decision to delegate policy implementation to firms. I then apply this theoretical framework to two substantive areas in the Indian context: the government's policy priority of increasing female labor force participation, and the government's decarbonization agenda.

Working Papers

Greener Pastures? A Labor Market Theory of Climate Governance *With Calvin Thrall & Noah Zucker*

Abstract: Climate governance requires access to climate experts: individuals with specialized knowledge of decarbonization and climate science. Here we model climate governance as the function of a competition between the state and private sector for a scarce pool of climate experts. Governments seek experts to develop and implement climate policies. Firms seek experts to affect policy choice, skirt enforcement, and measure climate risks to commercial interests. As firm interest in climate grows, the government's ability to attract experts declines, making it more reliant on the private sector for climate governance. To support this argument, we measure private sector demand for experts with unique data on U.S. job postings, paired with administrative data on government bureaucrats and procurement. Our findings offer a novel labor-based account of climate politics, contributing to the study of labor markets in political science, the sources of bureaucratic expertise, and the net effects of corporate social responsibility.

Journal Publications

Chatjuthamard, P., **Simran Singh**, P. Jiraporn, & Sang Mook Lee. (2024). "Climate Change Exposure, Shareholder Wealth, and the Adoption of the Paris Agreement: A Text-based Approach." *International Review of Financial Analysis*. 94.

C Jiraporn, P. Seksak Jumreornvong, N. Jiraporn, & **Simran Singh**. (2015). "How do independent directors view powerful CEOs? Evidence from a quasi-natural experiment." *Finance Research Letters*. 16.

Other Publications

Baraldi, Derek, Sayli Chitre, John Colas, Manuela Fulga, Ilya Khaykin & **Simran Singh**. (2021). "Financing the Transition to a Net-Zero Future." *World Economic Forum*.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Politics of International Economic Relations , Professor Jeffry Frieden	Fall 2024
Teaching Assistant, Introduction to International Relations , Professor Jayme Schlesinger	Spring 2024
Co-Instructor, Inside the Situation Room , Hillary Clinton and Dean Keren Yarhi-Milo	Fall 2023

Professional Research Experience

Research Assistant, Professor Nikhar Gaikwad, Columbia University	2022 – Current
Research Assistant, Professor Allison Carnegie, Columbia University	2022 – 2023
Research Assistant, Brookings Institute, Economic Studies	Summer 2016
Research Assistant, Professor Ayse Kaya, Swarthmore College	2014 – 2015

Other Professional Experience

Senior Consultant, Finance, Risk and Public Policy Practice, Oliver Wyman	2019 – 2022
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Service

Student Coordinator, Columbia University International Politics Seminar	Fall 2023 – Spring 2025
Founding Member, Columbia University Women in Political Science Student Group	Spring 2025
Student Coordinator, Columbia University International Economics and Geopolitics Seminar	Spring 2025
Member, Swarthmore Board of Managers' Social Responsibility Committee	2017 – 2019
Democracy Fellow, Campus Voter Project, Swarthmore College	2018 – 2019

Skills

Languages: English (native), Punjabi (native), Hindi (native), French (intermediate)
Software: R, Stata, LaTeX